

Jennifer James

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Professional Profile

17 years in Software Development, most of it spent on systems other teams depend on. Comfortable leading technical decisions, pushing back on scope when it matters, and carrying a pager for what I build. Primary tools: gRPC and Docker.

Qualifications

Bachelor, Mathematics

Stanford University | 2003 to 2007
First Class Honours

Tech Stack

gRPC (2 yr exp), Docker (14 yr exp), pytest (17 yr exp), Go (12 yr exp), CI/CD (14 yr exp), Angular (2 yr exp), REST APIs (2 yr exp), Vue.js (7 yr exp), TypeScript (1 yr exp), GraphQL (4 yr exp), React (9 yr exp), Scala (14 yr exp), Redis (18 yr exp), MySQL (12 yr exp), Python (6 yr exp), Postman (8 yr exp)

Work Experience

Backend Developer, Cobalt Systems

January 2014 to January 2026

- Replaced a third-party dependency with an in-house Python module, saving \$30k per year in licence fees.
- Drove the team's adoption of trunk-based development, reducing merge conflicts and lead time by 45%.
- Set the service-level objectives for 15 services and built the dashboards the team still runs on.
- Mentored 30 junior engineers, ran weekly design reviews, and authored the team's onboarding guide.

Junior Platform Engineer, Uber

February 2008 to January 2014

- Owned the customer-facing API end to end on TypeScript, from schema design through on-call support.
- Built a reusable REST APIs component library adopted by 15 product teams, removing months of duplicated work.
- Hardened authentication flows in REST APIs after a security review, closing 3 findings before audit.

Personal Projects

Recipe search engine

Full-text search over a scraped recipe corpus using TypeScript; learned more about ranking than about cooking.

Home energy dashboard

Collects meter readings and renders them with Docker. Mostly an excuse to learn time-series storage properly.

Certifications

Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) — Scrum.org, 2020
Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) — Microsoft, 2017
HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate — HashiCorp, 2025

Hobbies & Interests

Sailing, Home automation, Competitive pub quizzes, Baking